

Figure 1.1 *Congregational Mosque, Isfahan, Iran, founded tenth century* CE, *exterior: view from east.* © *Photograph Alka Patel 2011.*



Figure 1.2 *Congregational Mosque, Isfahan, 1086–1087* CE, *exterior: north dome.* © *Photograph Alka Patel 2011.*

(Figures 1.4–1.6), now known as *Chihil Dukhtaran* ("40 Daughters"), in the city's Jubara quarter (AH 501/1107–1108 CE).[38]

Other rungs of society emerged throughout Isfahan's prosperous surrounding areas. An "ascetic" (Pers. *zahid*) commissioned a sizeable *minar* and contiguous mosque at the village of Gar, with the date of AH 515/1121 CE and his name inscribed in simple Kufic on the *minar*'s octagonal plinth. And at the northern village of Sin, members of an important local family of *qadi*s patronized a mosque and *minar* (Figures 1.7–1.9) dated to AH 526/1132 CE and AH 529/1134–1135 CE, respectively – the *minar* bearing the earliest epigraphically dated exterior use of blue-glazed tiles for the Kufic *bismillah* at its current summit (Figure 1.9).[39]

Collectively, much of the enormous corpus of late eleventh–